

4 YEARS OF MODI GOVERNMENT 2.0

BOLD AND BRAVE

FACED WITH A POLYCRISIS, NARENDRA MODI PUSHED THROUGH DARING REFORMS TO WEATHER THE STORM. BUT THE CHALLENGE IS TO STAY THE COURSE

By RAJ CHENGAPPA

PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI'S PENCHANT FOR alliteration is well-known. Among his favourites is 2S: Speed and Scale. He is fond of saying that if the previous governments thought speed was a luxury and scale a risk, he as prime minister made "speed the ambition of India and scale its strength". Modi has demonstrated these qualities in ample measure in almost everything he has achieved in his nine years of office and more so in the four years of his second term.

The most recent example of this is the swank, state-of-the-art, hexagonal new Parliament building that he inaugurated on May 28. The complex came up at a remarkable speed, taking just two and a half years for completion despite Covid restrictions kicking in almost from the start. Then there is the scale. The new building has a seating capacity of 1,272